APTOHIRE

Problem Statement & Hypothesis

Why AptoHire should exist—and what must be proven

PRODUCT THESIS
Make practical capability visible through evidence—not just claims on a resume.

Product: AptoHire | **Website:** aptohire.vercel.app

Document: IDEA-01 | **Version:** 1.0 | **Date:** 30 October 2026

Audience: Hackathon judges, university partners, product team and prospective investors

This document separates founder-provided context, proposed product direction, and claims that require measured validation.

AptoHire

Executive summary

AptoHire is being developed as a talent ecosystem connecting students, universities, and employers. Its central thesis is that practical capability should be easier to demonstrate, inspect, and discover than it is through a resume alone. The initial customer priority identified by the founder is universities, with a long-term vision spanning the full talent ecosystem.

Problem statement
Capable students and early-career candidates can struggle to demonstrate practical ability through a resume alone. Employers have limited time to verify every claim, while universities need better visibility into demonstrated skills and readiness gaps.

The story behind the problem

The founder shared a LinkedIn anecdote about a candidate whose CV was rejected twice before an interview revealed their potential; the candidate later became a team leader. This is a compelling illustration of how a resume can underrepresent capability. It is an anecdote, not independently verified statistical evidence.

The problem across stakeholders

Stakeholder	Pain point	Potential consequence
Students / early-career talent	Projects and practical skills may be difficult to communicate in a trusted, comparable format.	Low visibility, repeated assessments, uncertainty about readiness.
Employers / recruiters	Skill claims are not consistently backed by inspectable evidence.	Screening burden, inconsistent evaluation, poor-fit hiring risk.
Universities / placement teams	Grades and placement outcomes do not fully expose practical skill depth or employer-demand gaps.	Training decisions are harder to target and demonstrate.
Talent ecosystem	Evidence is scattered across CVs, portfolios, tests and platforms.	Duplicated effort and weak portability of proof.

Proposed solution hypothesis

AptoHire proposes a portable, evidence-linked skill profile. Students submit project evidence and receive structured feedback; employers discover relevant profiles and request identity access; universities can use aggregate signals to understand skills and readiness gaps. These are product hypotheses and should be checked against the current deployed implementation.

Hypotheses and validation methods

ID	Hypothesis	Validation method
H1	Evidence-backed profiles improve recruiter confidence compared with CV-only profiles.	Blind comparison with recruiters using matched sample profiles.
H2	Students will complete a proof-building workflow if its value and privacy controls are clear.	Measure onboarding-to-submission conversion and abandonment.
H3	AI-assisted feedback is useful when tied to a transparent rubric and human review.	Compare AI outputs with blind human ratings.
H4	Anonymized discovery with consent-based identity reveal is acceptable.	Usability sessions and observed consent decisions.
H5	Universities will use aggregate skill-gap insights.	Test a placement-team workflow with a prototype.
H6	A buyer segment will pay for verification, discovery or analytics.	Price interviews and paid-pilot commitments.

Success metrics to test

Metric	Proposed pilot threshold	Status
Student submission completion	≥60% of onboarded students submit	Target only; not measured.
Recruiter inspection	Each pilot recruiter inspects at least five profiles	Target only; not measured.
AI–human agreement	Within one rubric level on ≥80% of reviewed sample	Target only; not measured.
Consent acceptance	≥50% of access requests accepted	Diagnostic target; not measured.

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Risks and counter-hypotheses

- Recruiters may like the idea but not change workflow or pay for another platform.
- Students may abandon lengthy assessments or distrust opaque AI scoring.
- AI may reward polished explanations instead of demonstrated competence unless evidence criteria are explicit.
- Anonymization can reduce some first-impression bias but does not guarantee fair outcomes.
- A universal score can create false confidence; show evidence, uncertainty, rubric version and appeals.
- A student-paid visibility model could undermine trust; validate institutional or employer payment first.

Conclusion
Proceed with a constrained prototype and customer discovery. Do not claim product-market fit, verified assessment accuracy, reduced hiring time or unbiased hiring until supported by measured evidence.